

# Uitgeest → Belchite — Backroads Route Booklet

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## A four-day motorcycle route through forgotten France & into Aragón

Wednesday noon departure · first night Verdun · through the Gorges de Galamus · Belchite by Saturday afternoon. Riding kept to 8–9 hours a day, camping each night, and built around quiet, overlooked places rather than the tour-bus stops.

**Legend** —  Start / End ·  Campsite (overnight) ·  Sight / stop along the road

**Note:** Day 1 (the motorway sprint out of the Low Countries to Verdun) is omitted from the original booklet on purpose — it's pure transit with nothing worth stopping for. The booklet starts where the riding gets good. It's included briefly below so the overnight (Verdun) has accommodation options.

## A note on the maps & distances

Each day is a schematic of the line and stops, drawn from verified coordinates — it shows sequence and shape, not turn-by-turn roads (load the GPX into your device for that). Times are estimates from those coordinates with road-winding and realistic riding speeds, not live routing; treat them as planning figures and sanity-check on your GPS.

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## Day 1 · Wednesday — Uitgeest → Verdun

*Motorway transit out of the Low Countries · ~6 h · pure highway, A2/E25*

The dull-but-necessary sprint south. A2 then E25 through Belgium and Luxembourg into Lorraine. Nothing to stop for — get the kilometres behind you and arrive in Verdun for the first camp.

### **Overnight — camping near Verdun**

- **Camping Les Breuils ★★★** — the main Verdun campsite, on the riverside ~20 min walk from the centre and the Citadelle; pool, bar-grill, grocery. The original route's planned stop. [campingfrance.com listing](https://campingfrance.com/listing) · [ACSI / Eurocampings](#)
  - **Camping Sous le Moulin — Charny-sur-Meuse** — small village campsite on the Meuse, ~10 min from Verdun, on the cycle path and at the foot of the battlefields. [camping-charnysurmeuse.jimdofree.com](https://camping-charnysurmeuse.jimdofree.com)
  - **CAMPING-CAR PARK "Sous le Moulin" — Charny-sur-Meuse** (*motorhome/aire, secured 24/7*) — from ~€9.90/24 h, full services, riverside. Handy fallback if Les Breuils is full. [campingcarpark.com](https://campingcarpark.com)
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## Day 2 · Thursday — Verdun to Langeac

### *Morvan forests & the wild Gorges de l'Allier*

~8.5–9 h riding · longest day · motorway start, then all backroads · camp on the Allier

The day opens on motorway — A31 then A6 — to get the dull kilometres behind you fast. Exit at Saulieu and the rest is D-roads: across the granite Morvan, over the Loire at Decize, then a long drop into volcanic Auvergne and the mouth of the Allier gorges. This is the longest day of the trip; the highway head-start is what keeps it inside your window.

#### Sights & quiet places along the road

1. **Saulieu** — Where you leave the A6 and the real ride begins. Old Burgundy market town if you need fuel or a first coffee.
2. **Saut de Gouloux** — A short forest path to a quiet waterfall, sitting right on the D977bis — essentially no detour. Out of season you may have it to yourself.
3. **Moulins-Engilbert** — A sleepy Morvan bourg with an old market square and almost no visitors. Good legs-stretch and photo stop.
4. **Chilhac** — A tiny village ringed by basalt columns on a spur above the Allier. Overlooked and genuinely peaceful — goat cheese and an artisan biscuit-maker in the village.

**Where to stop for lunch: Lac des Settons (Morvan).** Lakeside spots around the reservoir make an easy mid-morning–noon break with water views before you drop south. If you'd rather push on, **Decize** on the Loire has riverside cafés roughly at the midpoint.

**Places to avoid: Vézelay** — beautiful but a UNESCO tour-bus magnet, and east of your line; skipping it saves time and crowds. Also resist dropping into **Nevers** proper; the ring-road traffic costs you on an already long day.

**Faster alternative (the long day):** If the day runs long once it's loaded on your GPS, the release valve is to skip the Morvan loop (stops 2–3): stay on the A6 to roughly Mâcon/Paray-le-Monial latitude before cutting west to the Allier. That trades the forest backroads for motorway and buys back close to an hour — handy if you started late or the weather turns. The scenic Morvan version is the better ride; the fast version is the safety net.

#### **Overnight — camping near Langeac (on the Allier)**

- **Camping des Gorges de l'Allier ★★★ — Langeac** — the planned stop: large wooded riverside park 5 min from the town centre, at the very mouth of the gorges; pool, chalets, gîte d'étape. Avenue Jean-Baptiste Tuja, 43300 Langeac · ☎ +33 4 71 77 05 01. [campinglangeac.com](http://campinglangeac.com) (official) · [Pitchup booking](#)
  - **VVF Les Gorges de l'Allier — Lavoûte-Chilhac (~13 km)** — 3-star holiday village in one of France's prettiest villages, heated pool; good if you want a chalet rather than a tent. [campings.com listing](#)
  - **Camping Municipal de Chilhac (~ at sight #4)** — small, simple riverside municipal pitch right at the basalt village of Chilhac; cheap and quiet. [france-voyage.com](http://france-voyage.com) area listing
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## Day 3 · Friday — Langeac to Galamus

### *Allier gorges, the infant Loire & hidden volcanic castles*

~6.5 h riding · zero motorway · the wild day · sleep at the foot of Galamus

The pure day — not a metre of motorway. You follow the Allier gorges, climb to the volcanic country where the Loire is still a stream, cross the lonely Margeride, and come down the edge of the Cévennes to camp right under the Gorges de Galamus. Sleeping here is the key move: it puts Galamus at your doorstep for Saturday and keeps the final day short.

#### Sights & quiet places along the road

1. **Cave Chapel Sainte-Madeleine, Monistrol-d'Allier** — A chapel built into the rock above the Allier, on the old pilgrim road. Often missed; a lovely, cool picnic spot.
2. **Arlempdes** — A ruined castle on a volcanic plug over the headwaters of the Loire. A real hidden gem — in the off-season there is essentially nobody here.
3. **Pradelles** — A forgotten hilltop village on a historic route, with a quiet cobbled square and big open views over the Allier high country.
4. **Cascade de Rûnes** — An off-radar waterfall reached by a short, rocky path on Mont Lozère. Free, and usually empty.

**Where to stop for lunch: Pradelles.** The hilltop square (stop 3) is the natural lunch halt — a village café and somewhere to sit out of the wind, roughly halfway and with the best views of the day.

**Langogne**, just south, is the fallback for a fuller meal.

**Places to avoid: Le Puy-en-Velay.** It's close and tempting, but the Rocher Saint-Michel and the cathedral pull big crowds and city traffic. Skirt it — the quieter Allier/Loire villages above are the whole point of this corridor.

#### **Overnight — camping near Galamus (Saint-Paul-de-Fenouillet)**

- **Camping de l'Agly — Saint-Paul-de-Fenouillet** — small, simple campsite ~5 km from the gorge mouth; tents, vans and a couple of cottages. The planned base, puts Galamus on your doorstep for the dawn ride. [Pitchup booking](#) · [gorgesdegalamus.fr camping guide](https://gorgesdegalamus.fr/camping-guide)
  - **Camping des Randonneurs — Fenouillet** — wooded 2.5 ha park with a view over the village and its two Cathar castles; on-site restaurant and Finnish Kota-grill. [gorgesdegalamus.fr/camping-des-randonneurs](https://gorgesdegalamus.fr/camping-des-randonneurs)
  - **Camping La Tour de France — Latour-de-France (~15 km)** — slightly larger campsite in Côtes-du-Roussillon wine country if you want more facilities. [camping-latourdefrance.fr](https://camping-latourdefrance.fr)
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## Day 4 • Saturday — Galamus to Belchite

### *The gorge at dawn, a quiet Cathar castle & the Aragón plains*

~7 h riding • some Spanish motorway • arrive Belchite by afternoon

Ride the Galamus balcony road first thing, before the cars — the gorge is narrow and best had empty. One quiet castle, then west through Cathar back roads, across the border at Le Perthus, and let the empty, sun-baked Aragón plains carry you into Belchite. A short, dramatic finish after two big days.

#### Sights & quiet places along the road

1. **Gorges de Galamus & Ermitage Saint-Antoine** — A 7th-century hermit chapel clinging to the cliff above the Agly, on a vertiginous one-lane balcony road. Go at opening time.
2. **Château de Quéribus** — The quieter Cathar castle — smaller and more intense than its famous neighbour, with a huge panorama and a fraction of the crowds.
3. **Le Perthus** — The natural Pyrenean crossing toward Aragón — no backtracking. Last cheap fuel before Spain.

**Where to stop for lunch: Cucugnan / below Quéribus.** The little villages under the castle (Cucugnan, Maury) do simple country plates and local wine — eat here, before the border, because options thin out fast once you're on the Aragón plains.

**Places to avoid: Château de Peyrepertuse & the Puigcerdà crossing.** Peyrepertuse draws the tour traffic; Quéribus next door is the better, quieter call. And do **not** cross at Puigcerdà/C-14 — it sits ~70 km the wrong way west and adds a needless backtrack. Le Perthus is the line.

#### **Arrival — hotels & hostels in Belchite (no campsites)**

Belchite has no campground, so book a room. It's a small town (famous for its Civil-War ruins), so options are limited — **reserve ahead**, especially on a Saturday night.

- **Hotel Oleum** — modern 2-star in the old Casino building in the centre; 12 rooms (double/triple/family/suite). The most hotel-like option. [hoteloleum.es](https://hoteloleum.es) (official, book direct)
  - **Hostal Restaurante Pueblo Viejo** — simple hostel with its own restaurant and free parking; handy for an evening meal on arrival. [Booking.com](https://www.booking.com)
  - **Casa Rural Legus Belikiom** — well-rated guesthouse (≈9.7) at Calle Mayor 56; 3 bedrooms, kitchen, private parking, A/C. Good for a self-catered finish. ☎ +34 659 828 672. [Booking.com](https://www.booking.com)
  - **More / compare all Belchite stays** — including Apartahotel Belchite and nearby village options. [Booking.com](https://www.booking.com) — [Belchite](#)
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